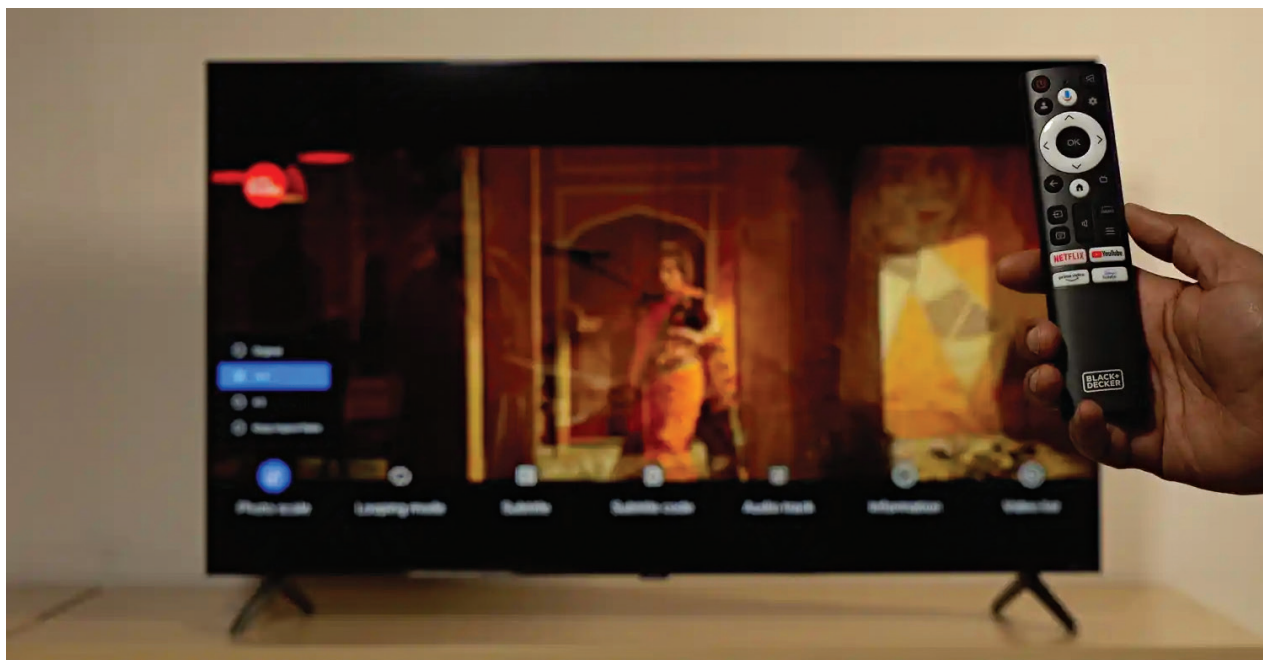




the colour checker stats look significantly better. We also noticed that the lack of a wide colour gamut impacts HDR scenes which results in a lack of pop and paler skin tones.

Compared to other affordable TVs, the AI does a decent job with upscaling legacy content. Motion handling is reasonably smooth as well.

GAMING AND AUDIO

The Acer Super Series QLED TV supports useful gaming features like HDMI 2.1 connectivity with ALLM and 120Hz motion accelerator, which do make a difference. The gaming experience with the console and PC exceeded our expectations. The gameplay felt smooth and responsive considering the price.

The TV has a 36W Audio System with Dolby Audio support. The sound stage is wide and dialogue clarity is above average. No complaints here.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

This TV has a 'Dual AI Processor', which is a quad-core processor backed by 2GB RAM and 16GB storage. The performance is not particularly snappy but it is once again decent for the asking price. The Google TV software is based on the

latest Android TV 14 with some basic customisations on top. There are several useful extras like the Fastconnect option that bundles all casting and mirroring options in one place. It also includes a workable alternative to Apple Airplay for mirroring from iPhones. Some other useful features include meeting mode, world clock and Enjoy music mode which you can use to turn off the display while listening to music.

DESIGN AND REMOTE

The TV has a very customary design with narrow bezels and a metallic back. The Black + Decker branding is on the Power button module.

The feet are made of polycarbonate but have a metallic finish. There is a decent assortment of connectivity ports on the rear and they are also easy to access. The remote is quite familiar and ergonomic. The build quality is at par with what we usually see with affordable TVs. The odd thing is the Menu button, which is not for the TV menu but for playback controls when content is playing via USB.

Apart from hotkeys for four popular apps, you get a few extra buttons like the Smart button for additional software ad-ons.

VERDICT

So, overall, Black + Decker AI seems to be a well-rounded affordable option. Compromises have been made and that's understandable, but overall the TV offers good value. You get excellent colour accuracy in SDR, high contrast and decent HDR performance with Dolby Vision support. The 36W audio system and gaming performances are additional perks that add value.

For a slightly higher price, you can also get some decent-performing QLED options like Acer Super Series 55-inch TV and TCL C645B.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Display Size: 55-inch, VA LCD | Display Resolution: 3840 x 2160 – 4K UHD | Panel Refresh Rate: 60Hz | Supported HDR Formats: Dolby Vision, HDR10, HLG | Speakers: 36W | Audio formats: Supports Dolby Audio | Software: Google TV (Android 14) | HDMI Ports: 3x HDMI (120Hz VRR, ALLM, eARC) | Processor: Dual AI Quad-Core processor | RAM and Storage: 2GB RAM and 16GB storage | Other connectivity options: USB 2.0, USB 3.0, Dual-band Wi-Fi, Optical input, Bluetooth 5.2 Ethernet, Antenna input, AV in

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